

SPACE LAUNCH SYSTEM

Rocket

The escape tower will pull the Orion capsule clear in case of an emergency

Orion capsule inside here

The Space Launch System (SLS), NASA's new rocket, will be the most powerful ever built. Powered by the same engines used in the space shuttle, with similar boosters, it is not reusable. Its Orion capsule has been designed to carry a crew of four astronauts beyond Earth orbit, to land on an asteroid or the Moon and – eventually – to travel to Mars.

The SLS will be launched from the Kennedy Space Centre in Florida, USA.

The solid-rocket boosters fire for 126 seconds before being jettisoned

DATA FILE



SIZE: 65 m (213 ft) tall



PLANNED DATE OF LAUNCH:
November 2018



SPACE AGENCY: NASA